



Quick Start Guide

An introduction to the app

Legado is a desktop application for cataloging, documenting and analyzing numismatic collections: coins, banknotes and other pieces. This guide walks you through the app's sections and their main tools.

The app comes in two editions: **Legado Basic**, free of charge, and **Legado Pro**, a one-time purchase (no subscriptions) that includes a license for two devices. Throughout this guide, features exclusive to the Pro edition are marked with **PRO**. The table in section 2 compares both editions in detail.

Beyond this guide, the app itself includes a help panel: open it with the ⓘ icon. It contains over 50 searchable articles explaining every feature in detail.

Getting started

If this is your first time opening Legado and you would rather start with something practical, here is the minimum:

1. Press the add button to create your first item.
2. Fill in only what you know. No field is required and everything can be completed later.
3. Add a photograph: click the photo box to choose the file, or drag it straight onto the box from wherever you keep it.
4. Confirm. You now have your first record.

None of this is final: fields can be created, renamed and reordered as you like, and your collection can be imported from a spreadsheet if you already keep one.

That is enough to get started. The rest of the guide explains each section in detail, and there is no need to read it straight through.

1 System requirements

- **Mac:** macOS 11 or later, with an Apple Silicon processor (M1 or newer).
- **Windows:** Windows 10 or later, 64-bit.
- **Display:** 1440 × 900 resolution or higher. The minimum is 1280 × 800.

Legado works offline for managing and browsing your collection. An internet connection is only needed for the features that query external data: the map, intrinsic value and currency conversion, the Numista and *Online Coins of the Roman Empire* (OCRE) catalogs, the artificial intelligence assistant, and updates.

2 Legado Basic and Legado Pro

	Legado Basic	Legado Pro
Your collection		
Registered items	Up to 50	Unlimited
Import from Excel & CSV	✓	✓
Automated photo import	✓	✓
Photos, videos & documents	✓	✓
Documentation & catalogs		
Numista & OCRE Roman coinage catalog lookups *	✓	✓
AI-assisted historical context generation for items	—	✓
AI-assisted item identification and cataloguing	—	✓
Photo annotations	—	✓
Notes (Sticky notes)	Up to 5	Unlimited
Bibliography reference library with direct linking to items	—	✓
Views		
Image gallery (6 modes)	✓	✓
Comparative viewer	✓	✓
Explore items on maps	✓	✓
Light mode / Dark mode	✓	✓
Analysis & planning		
Statistics	—	✓
Acquisition plan & reminders	Up to 5 items	Unlimited
Export & printing		
Export to Excel & CSV	CSV only	✓
Export coin records to PDF	—	✓
Label generator	—	✓
Support & updates		
Updates	✓	✓
Access to new features	—	✓
Technical support	—	✓
Available in English, French, German and Spanish	✓	✓

* Numista lookups require a free API key available at numista.com.

3 How the app is organized

The main menu contains eight icons, one per section:

Icon	Section	Contents
	Collection	Your registered items. Two complementary views: Gallery (photo cards, for browsing and filtering) and List (a table, for editing, importing and exporting). Each view has tools of its own.
	Analysis PRO	Statistics and charts for your collection (requires Legado Pro).
	Maps	Your collection on the map: mints and countries.
	Goals	The pieces you are looking for, with date reminders.
	Queries PRO	Identifies unknown items — coins, medals, tokens and banknotes — from photos, with the help of artificial intelligence and comparison against the Numista and OCRE catalogues (requires Legado Pro).
	Notes	Free-form notes about your collection.
	Library PRO	Organizes bibliographic documentation —books, catalogues, articles— in folders and links it to the items it documents (requires Legado Pro).
	Settings	App configuration and license management.

Next to the main menu sit the switch between **light mode and dark mode** (sun or moon icon) and the help icon . The collection name is shown only when the menu sits along the top.

Hovering the cursor over any icon in the app shows a brief description of what it does — the quickest way to discover what each button is for.

The main menu appears on the left-hand side by default. From Settings → Appearance you can move it to the top of the window and set it to hide automatically: it disappears while you work and reappears when the pointer approaches the edge of the window.

4 Creating your first item

The first time you open Legado, the app shows the **Collection** section in the **List** view, with a message offering the three ways to begin: creating a item manually, importing an Excel file or restoring an existing backup. To create a item manually:

1. Click the add button  in the toolbar. A new record opens.
2. Enter whatever data you wish. No field is mandatory, and all of them can be completed later. The Tab key moves to the next field.
3. To add photographs, click the photo box and select an image. Each time a photograph is added, a slot opens for the next one. The ★ star shown over each photo lets you set it as the **main photo** (the one displayed in the Gallery).
4. Finish with the confirm button in the record's top bar. Auto-save is on by default, so changes are stored as you type; it can be turned off in Settings → Data, in which case the record shows a floppy-disk button  for saving manually.

Status indicator: in the header of each record, a green circle ☺ means the record is complete, and an amber triangle ⚠ that some data is still missing. Click it to change it, and use it as a filter to find unfinished records.

5 Your data

Legado keeps your whole collection in a single folder on your computer. Inside there are two things: a file called legado.db, which holds your record data, and a “fotos” folder with the photographs, videos and attached documents.

You can see and change where that folder is in Settings → Data. If you place it in a folder synced to the cloud, you will have an automatic remote copy.

Your data is yours and does not depend on the app continuing to exist: your collection can be exported at any time to CSV, a format any spreadsheet opens, and to Excel in the Pro version.

Backups. Legado makes an automatic copy when it closes, once a day. It is a useful safety net, but it lives on the same computer as the original data, so it does not protect you from a failed disk or a theft.

That is why it is worth creating a full backup every now and then and keeping it somewhere else — an external drive, another computer or the cloud:

1. Go to Collection → List and press the export button.
2. Choose the “Legado” option.
3. Save the .zip file it generates. It contains the database and every attached file: it is your entire collection.

To restore that copy on another computer, or after a problem, use the import button in that same bar and choose the backup. A collection documented over years fits into that single file: it is worth doing every few weeks and keeping it away from the computer.

6 Importing a collection from Excel

If your collection already lives in a spreadsheet, you can move it into Legado in minutes without retyping anything. The starting point is an Excel file (.xlsx or .xls) or a CSV with a **header row** naming each column, and one row per item.

1. In **Collection** → **List**, click the import button ⬇ and choose **Excel** or **CSV**.
2. Choose the type of objects you are importing (coin, banknote, medal or token) and select the file. This choice matters: each record shows different fields depending on the type. A banknote has printer, signatories or material, while a coin has mint, diameter and die axis. If you get it wrong here, records will show the fields of the wrong type.
3. **Map each column to a Legado field.** The mapping screen shows every column in the file with a preview of its content and a “Legado field” dropdown to choose the destination field. When a column name matches a field, Legado maps it automatically; the rest can be assigned by hand, and columns you do not need can be set to “— Skip —”. Your spreadsheet therefore does not need to use Legado’s exact field names.

4. Preview and confirm. Before importing, Legado shows the first rows exactly as they will be stored. If a item already exists in the collection (same collection code), you are warned: on confirming, those items are updated with the file's data instead of being duplicated.

5. Click the import button. The data can be reviewed and edited afterwards, individually or in bulk.

Tip: not sure what your spreadsheet columns should be called? You do not have to guess. Register one item by hand, export the collection to CSV (or to Excel in the Pro version) and open the file: it will have one column per Legado field, with its exact name. Use that file as a template to pour in the rest of your collection.

Once the data is in, **photographs can be imported in bulk**. The collection code is the reference you assign to each item to identify it in your collection — it is optional, but very useful here: name each image file with the code of the item it belongs to and use the photo import option. Legado will assign them to their records automatically.

7 The item record

The record holds all the information about a piece. It opens when you click any row in the List. In the Gallery, cards without a photograph open the record directly; those with a photograph open the image full screen first, from where you can consult a short information panel or open the full record. Either way, the record can be adapted to the way you collect:

- **Automatic title** — the header of each record shows a title generated automatically from the item's fields (for example, "Denarius · 44 BC · Julius Caesar"). The format is defined in Settings → Appearance, "Record title format" section, combining the available fields — denomination, year, issuing entity and authority, mint, metal, grade, catalog reference or collection code — with free text and separators.
- **Field groups** — fields are organized into groups (identification, design, cataloging, market...) that you move through using the row of tabs at the top of the record.
- **Basic or full record** — the button to the right of that row switches between showing only the essential fields or every field.
- **Custom fields** — in Settings → Fields you can create new fields, rename them, reorder them by dragging, and enable or disable them. The record reflects changes instantly. They can also be reordered from the record itself, outside edit mode, by dragging the field name; the move only works within the same group.
- **Mints with a location** — when you type the mint's name, if it is in Legado's database, coordinates are assigned automatically and the item appears on the map. The location can also be set by hand, entering coordinates in the location field.
- **Attached documents** — besides photographs and videos, the record accepts documents such as invoices, certificates of authenticity, grading reports and other paperwork. All of it is stored in Legado's data folder along with the rest of your collection, so it is included in backups.
- **Your code as a reference** — if you give each item an collection code of your own, attached files (photographs, documents...) are stored using that code in their file names, which makes them easy to find in the data folder.
- **External references** — the record also accepts links to web pages or to files on your computer, which open directly from it.

Catalogs and artificial intelligence assistant

In edit mode, the record's top bar offers three tools for documenting the piece:

Numista

The open-book icon  opens the catalog menu; the Numista option imports the piece's data from that collaborative catalog (coins, banknotes and more).

- **Numista ID** — every coin type on numista.com has a unique numeric identifier, visible in the web address of its page (the number in `pieces12345.html`). Legado has a dedicated field, “Numista ID”: if the record has it filled in, clicking the icon loads that type's data directly, with no search step. And when you import a result found by searching, the identifier is saved to that field automatically for future lookups.
- **Keyword search** — if the record has no Numista ID, Legado runs an automatic search combining the fields already registered: first the catalog reference if there is one, then denomination, issuing entity and year, and finally without the year; it keeps the first that returns results. When searching by hand, use few, specific words — denomination, country and year: “2 pesetas 1870”, “thaler Maria Theresia” — and avoid generic terms such as “old silver coin”. Giving the year narrows results considerably and, if it is a specific year, its issue is preselected too.
- **Fields to import** — once the right reference is found, tick the fields you want to bring into the record. Only the fields with “Enable Numista assistant for this field” turned on in Settings → Fields are offered.

OCRE

Available from the same catalogs menu: the academic catalog of ancient Roman coinage, free and with nothing to configure.

- **Searching** — the American Numismatic Society's catalog is searched in English. If the record already has a catalog reference (for example, “RIC I 1A”), that value is used as the initial query; otherwise the denomination and issuing authority are combined. Examples of effective searches: “Augustus denarius”, “Domitian RIC 821”.
- **External reference** — when fields are imported, a link to the original entry at numismatics.org/ocre is also added to the record.

Artificial intelligence assistant **PRO**

Next to the “Historical Context” field, the “ Generate with AI” button automatically writes the historical background of the piece. Artificial intelligence features are paid for with credits, and the Pro licence includes 500. Today the only one that uses them is this historical context generation: each generated text uses one credit. You can check your balance in Settings → Services.

- **Fields used** — the text is built from the record's fields: denomination, date of issue, issuing entity and authority, mint, composition, obverse and reverse descriptions, and catalog references. If these fields are missing or incomplete, the generated text may be inaccurate or incomplete — always review it.

8 Collection

In this section's toolbar, the **Gallery**  | **List**  selector switches between the two views of your collection.

Gallery

Shows your items as photo cards. Its toolbar brings together text search , filters — which narrow the view down by one or several fields at once — and the sort and group menus, which order the collection by any field and split the cards into sections (by country, metal, grade...). On the right you choose the card size — compact, normal or large, with your preference remembered — switch between coins and banknotes, and reach the «Photos only» view, Immersive view, the label generator and the button to create a new item. When you open a photograph you can enlarge it to full screen with the magnifier , annotate on it  or compare two items side by side .

Below the photograph, each card shows up to **four lines of information**, with one field on the left and another on the right of each line; the first line is the most prominent. To choose which fields appear, click the wrench icon in the Gallery toolbar: changes apply instantly, while the panel is still open, with nothing to save.

List

Shows the collection as a table, one row per item. Its toolbar gathers the main operations:

- Add a item .
- Turn on **edit mode** , which lets you both edit individual values by clicking directly on a table cell and select several items to edit or delete in bulk.
- **Import**  from Excel, CSV, photos in bulk or a backup.
- **Export**  to CSV, to Excel **PRO**, to PDF **PRO** or create a full backup.
- **Labels**  **PRO** — opens the label generator for your trays and cabinets (see section 8).

9 Labels and PDF records **PRO**

Two tools put your collection on paper, built from the fields of each record.

Label generator

Designed for documenting items in trays and coin cabinets. Open it from the **Collection** section, in either of its two views, with the “**Labels**”  button. The process:

- **Selection** — tick the items you want in the left-hand panel; the “All” and “None” buttons select in bulk.
- **Format** — label size chosen from the presets or with custom dimensions, paper size (A4 or Letter), and adjustable margins and spacing between labels.
- **Content** — which fields appear: a first line in bold (the main title), a secondary second line and additional inline fields.
- **Design** — font, text size, alignment and border of each label. The **two-sided** option includes the obverse and reverse photographs.

- **Preview and generation** — the right-hand panel shows in real time the resulting number of columns, rows and pages. The “Generate labels” button creates a print-ready PDF.

You can save a template with your preferred label design, so the whole collection keeps a consistent look.

PDF item records

It is generated from Collection → List, turning on edit mode, or from a single record with the “Export to PDF” button. It produces a document with detailed records of the chosen items — useful for appraisals, insurance, trades, or simply to keep a printed catalogue.

- **Selection** — in **Collection** → **List**, turn on edit mode  and tick the items to export. A single item can also be exported from its own record, with the “Export PDF” button.
- **Setup** — the export panel lets you set the file name, decide whether each item’s main photo is included, and choose which fields appear in the body of each record. The field marked with the star (★) acts as the title.
- **Generation** — the “Export PDF” button asks for a destination folder and creates the document, one record per item.

10 Analysis PRO

The  **Analysis** section shows your collection in numbers: summary cards (number of items, total investment, oldest piece...), distribution charts by metal, grade or any other field, and the acquisition timeline. Each distribution can be shown as **horizontal bars**, **vertical bars**, **a donut chart or a ranking**; the timeline is drawn as a line chart with area. For gold and silver coins it also includes the **intrinsic value**: the value of each coin’s precious metal based on its weight, fineness and the market spot price, updated hourly.

The wrench icon  in the toolbar lets you choose which cards and charts are displayed.

11 Maps

The  **Maps** section offers four modes, selected in the map’s top bar:

- **Mints**  — one marker per minting location, with the number of items. Clicking a marker shows the corresponding items, from which each record can be opened. For a item to appear on this map, the exact location of its mint must have been set in its record beforehand: when you type the name, if it is in Legado’s database, coordinates are assigned automatically; otherwise they can be set by hand in the location field.
- **Countries - Coins** , **Countries - Banknotes**  and **Countries - Coins & banknotes** — color the countries represented in your collection. For a country to be colored, the item’s issuing entity must be the common name of a present-day country (“France”, not “French Republic”). Historical entities such as “Roman Empire” do not appear on these present-day maps.

With the Mints mode active, the **“Roman Empire”** button overlays the Empire’s 53 provinces (2nd century AD). The map needs an internet connection to load the base map; areas already visited are cached and available offline.

12 Goals

The  **Goals** section is your register of wanted pieces. The + button adds a goal, where you can note the category, the search status (Active search, Under observation, Bidding...), priority, target price, deadline, photographs and links to auctions or dealers.

- **Reminders**  — each goal can have an alert date and time. On that day, Legado shows a system notification at the chosen time and a badge over the Goals icon in the main menu.
- **Goal achieved**  — the trophy button turns the goal into a new item in your collection, carrying over the compatible data.
- The goals list can be exported to PDF  . **PRO**

13 Queries **PRO**

The Queries section identifies unknown items — coins, medals, tokens or banknotes — from photographs, with the assistance of artificial intelligence and checking against the Numista catalogue and, for Imperial Roman coinage, OCRE too. The analysis is optimised for coins; for medals, tokens and banknotes the result may be less precise.

1. Choose the item type — coin, medal, token or banknote. This sets the photo frame shape and the Numista catalogue category used for the search.
2. Upload a photo of the obverse (required) and, if you can, the reverse (optional, but it improves accuracy).
3. Fill in the optional data if you know it — not required, but it helps: weight, diameter and metal (or width, height and material for banknotes), plus a free-text «Other info» field for any extra detail.
4. Tap «Identify item». The query cost and your available credit balance are shown just above the button; with fewer than 5 credits, the button is disabled.

Interpreting the result

- If the identification of the item has a high degree of confidence and is confirmed in the catalogue, between 1 and 4 relevant results are shown. The + icon  creates an entry with the selected data; the bookmark icon  saves the query without creating any entry; the X icon  dismisses that candidate. If all are dismissed, a message appears with the option to go back.
- If the item could not be catalogued accurately, the relevant information found is shown, though unverified. You can also create an entry  with that partial data, or save the query .
- If the confidence level is very low or absent, it is indicated that the item could not be identified. You can still create an entry  — useful if you just want to keep the photos — or save the query .

The bookmark icon  in the Queries top bar opens the list of saved queries: thumbnails, title, issuer, years, reference and date for each one. It is independent from the collection: saving or deleting a query does not create, change or delete any entry.

The reset icon  in the top bar clears the photos and the optional data to start a new query.

Each query has a minimum cost of 1 credit. If the item is identified — fully or partially — 4 additional credits are charged, for a total of 5. These credits are drawn from the same credit balance as historical context generation (see section 17).

14 Notes

The  **Notes** section holds free-form notes: observations, to-dos or any other remarks about your collection. Each note has a title, a body and one of seven colors. The pin  keeps important notes at the top of the list, and the  button exports all notes to PDF. **PRO**

15 Library **PRO**

The Library section organizes your reference documentation —books, catalogues, articles, saved web pages— into folders, and lets you link each document to the items it documents. It opens from the main menu and shows three columns: the folder tree, the documents in the selected folder, and the details of the active document, with its linked items.

- **Folders** — created with the  button in the left-hand column; they can be nested inside one another and renamed at any time. A folder can only be deleted once it is empty, with no subfolders or documents inside.
- **Documents** — each document has a title and, optionally, author, publisher, year, edition, ISBN and notes. It is also classified by **Format** —local file, cloud file, web link or physical document (this last one a reference with no digital file, with its shelf location)— and, optionally, by **Type**: Book, Catalogue, Auction catalogue, Magazine, Article, Web page, Thesis or Other.
- **Search** — the search bar at the top of the Library finds documents by title or author across your whole reference collection, without browsing through folders.
- **Linking items** — in each document's details, the  button next to “Linked items” finds and links items from your collection to the document. A document can be linked to several items, and an item can have several linked documents.
- **Linking from the record** — the “Bibliography” section of each item's record (see section 7) shows its linked documents, lets you open and unlink them, and search for and link others without leaving the record. In the Gallery, the books icon in each photo's info panel offers the same quick access (see section 8).
- **In Legado Basic** — the Library is not available, but documents linked earlier with Legado Pro are still shown on the item's record and can be opened; only the ability to create, edit or link new documents is lost.

16 Settings

The  **Settings** section is organized into tabs:

- **Fields** — create, edit and reorder the fields used in your records.
- **Appearance** — collection name (shown next to the main menu when it sits along the top, and in PDF exports), language, typography, date, number and currency formats, and the menu's position and behavior.

- **Data** — storage folder, auto-save, automatic daily copy (made when the app closes and once a day), an access password for the app, and the diagnostic file for support **PRO**.
- **Services** — your Numista key and the artificial intelligence assistant's credit balance. To get the key: create a free account at numista.com, request it from your user profile and paste it here.
- **Legado** — license activation and app updates.

17 Automatic updates

On launch, Legado checks whether a new version exists and, if so, downloads it in the background while you work — without interrupting at any point. When the download is ready, a notice appears with the “**Restart and install**” button. Installation only happens once you accept it by clicking that button: the app then closes, updates and reopens by itself (the process can take a minute or two). If you prefer to keep working, simply dismiss the notice; it will be offered again later.

18 Activating Legado Pro

The Legado Pro license is purchased at legadonumis.com with a one-time payment — no subscriptions. After payment, you receive by email a **license key** — perpetual, and valid for using Legado Pro on **up to two computers at the same time**.

To activate it: in  **Settings, Legado** tab, enter the key and click “**Activate**”. An internet connection is only needed at that moment.

Switching computers. Since the license covers two computers, it is usually enough to activate it on the new one as well. If it is already active on two, first deactivate it on one of them (same tab, deactivate button) to free up that slot. Your collection is never affected.

Artificial intelligence assistant credits. The license includes 500 credits, shared between the two AI features: historical context generation (1 credit each time) and identification queries in the Queries section (1 to 5 credits, depending on the result). The balance is shown in Settings, Services tab, where additional 200-credit packs can also be purchased.

19 Help and support

The  icon opens the Help panel, with more than 50 searchable articles explaining every feature in detail.

Legado Pro users also have **direct technical support** at contacto@legadonumis.com.

20 If something does not work as expected

My items do not appear on the mints map. The map needs the exact location of the mint, not just its name. When you type the name in the record, if it is in Legado's database the coordinates are assigned automatically; if not, you can set them by hand from the location field.

A country is not coloured on the map. The issuing entity must be the common name of a present-day country: “France”, not “French Republic”. Historical entities such as “Roman Empire” do not appear on present-day country maps.

Numista cannot find my coin. Try fewer, more specific words: denomination, country and year. Generic terms (“old silver coin”) do not work well. If you know the year, include it: it narrows results considerably. And if a warning says the key is missing, set it in Settings → Services.

I cannot find Analysis, Excel export or the label generator. These are Legado Pro features. The full comparison is in section 2.

I imported photographs in bulk and they were not assigned. Each image file must be named exactly like the collection code of the item it belongs to. If a item has no code, there is no way to match it.

I closed the record and I am not sure it was saved. Automatic saving is on by default: changes are stored as you type. If you turned it off in Settings → Data, the record shows a diskette button to save by hand.

The artificial intelligence assistant says there are no credits left. Historical context generation uses 1 credit, and a query to identify an item uses between 1 and 5 credits depending on the result; the Pro licence initially includes 500 credits, with additional credits available for purchase. You can check your balance in Settings → Services.

The “Identify item” button is disabled. A minimum balance of 5 credits is required to launch a query in the Queries section; below that, the button is disabled. Check your balance in Settings → Services.

21 Glossary

Terms that appear throughout the guide and in the app itself.

Field — each of the pieces of data that make up a record: denomination, year, metal, weight... You can create your own, rename them, reorder them and hide the ones you do not use.

Record — the screen that brings together all the information about a item, with its fields, photographs and attached documents.

Collection code — the reference you assign to each item to identify it in your collection — for example, ES0129. It is optional, but it is used to name attached files and to import photographs in bulk.

Object type — coin, banknote, medal or token. It determines which fields the record shows, because a banknote and a coin, medal or token do not share them all.

Mint — the place where the piece was struck. If Legado recognises its name it assigns coordinates and the item appears on the map; if not, the coordinates can be entered by hand from the location field.

Issuing entity and issuing authority — the entity is the state or territory issuing the piece (e.g. Spain, Roman Empire); the authority is who issues it in its name (e.g. Charles VII, Augustus).

Issue — in modern coinage, the specific striking of a type in a given year and mint. A single type may have dozens of issues.

Catalogue reference — the identifier of the piece in a reference work — for example “KM# 5a.1” or “RIC I 30” — that allows it to be located unambiguously.

Credit — the unit consumed by the artificial intelligence features. The Pro licence includes 500. Additional 200-credit packs can also be purchased.